

LEAP 2025

Social Studies

Practice Test

Grade 4

Session 1 Directions

Directions:

Today, you will take Session 1 of the Grade 4 Social Studies Practice Test.

Read each source and question. Then, follow the directions to answer each question. Mark your answers by completely filling in the circles in your test booklet. Do not make any stray pencil marks outside of the circles. If you need to change an answer, be sure to erase your first answer completely. You may look back at the sources when needed.

Some of the questions will ask you to write a response. Write your response in the space provided in your test booklet. Only responses written within the provided space will be scored.

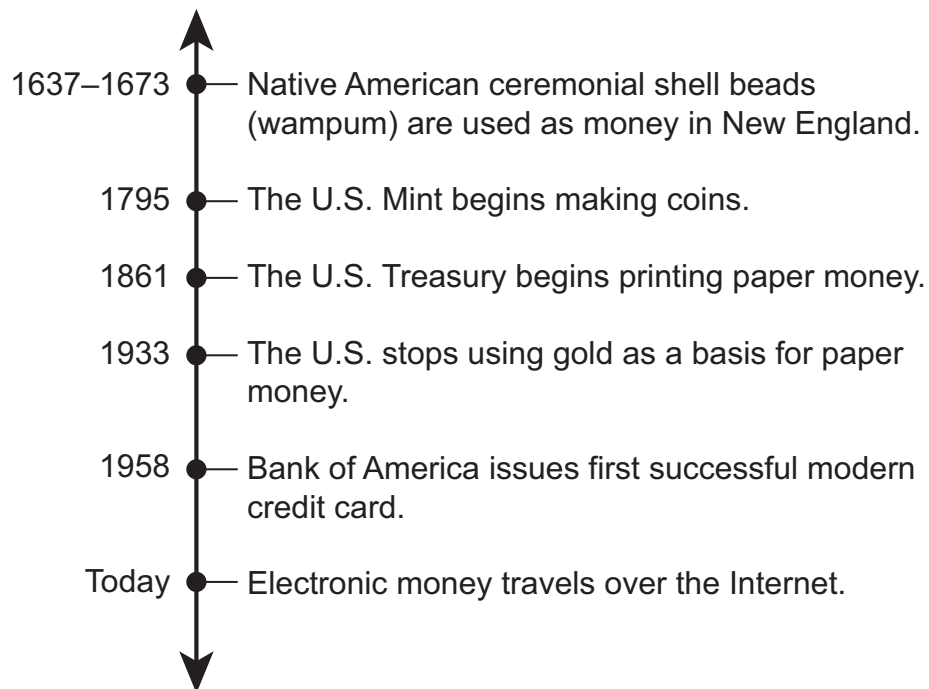
If you do not know the answer to a question, you may go on to the next question. If you finish early, you may review your answers and any questions you did not answer in this session **ONLY**. Do not go past the stop sign.

GO ON ►

Read and study the sources about the history of money and its use today. Then use the three sources and your knowledge of social studies to answer questions 1–4.

Source 1

The History of Money in North America



Source 2

The Country Editor—Paying the Yearly Subscription (1874)*by F. S. Church*

In this drawing, a man offers a rabbit in exchange for a newspaper subscription. This form of payment, called bartering, was once very common.



Social Studies

Source 3

**From *Brightside: The Essential Guide to Careers,
Education and Student Life***

Debit Cards

A debit card lets you pay for things with money from your bank account without needing cash. To use it you'll need your PIN¹ . . . which you enter into a card terminal² in shops, or into a website when buying things online. The money is normally deducted³ from your bank balance in one to two days.

Credit Cards

Using a credit card is similar to using a debit card. A credit card doesn't immediately deduct money from your bank account. This is because credit cards let you spend money the bank has lent you up to a certain limit every month. The bank then sends you a bill for the total amount of everything you've bought. You don't have to pay it back all at once, but you do pay interest on any money you haven't paid back.

¹**PIN:** personal identification number, a series of numbers known only to the cardholder and the bank

²**card terminal:** credit and debit card pay machine

³**deducted:** subtracted

Source 3: *Credit Cards and Debit Cards Explained*. Copyright © 2003–2016 Brightside. Reprinted by permission of the Brightside Trust.

1. Using Source 2, which statement **best** describes an advantage of bartering?
 - (A) People can set the price for things they buy.
 - (B) People can find a use for things that are otherwise useless.
 - (C) People can learn about new businesses in their neighborhood.
 - (D) People can get things they need even if they lack cash.

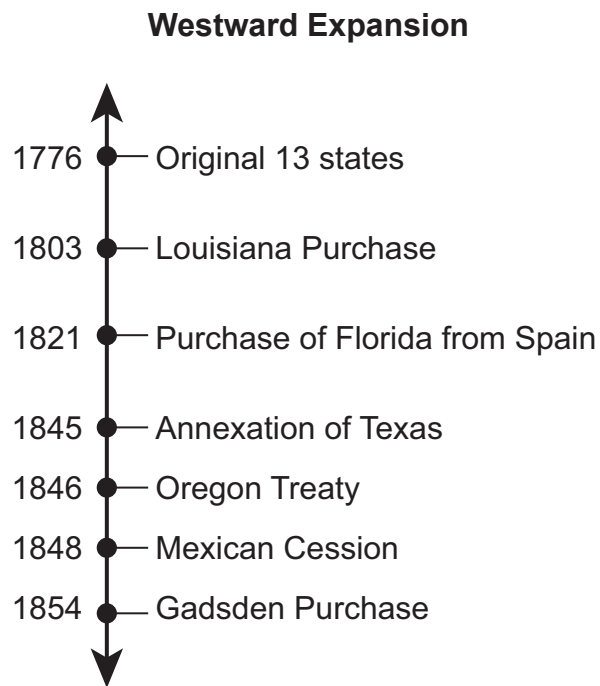
2. Which statement **best** describes an advantage of paper money over bartering?
 - (A) Paper money allows people to spend more than they can afford.
 - (B) Paper money allows people to pay for both goods and services.
 - (C) Paper money is worth the same amount in all stores.
 - (D) Paper money is protected by a secret PIN code.

3. Based on Source 3, which statement **best** explains the difference between a debit card and a credit card?
 - (A) A debit card can be used only at stores, while a credit card can be used only to pay bills.
 - (B) A debit card withdraws money from a bank account, while a credit card is a loan that must be paid back.
 - (C) A credit card requires cash in the bank, while a debit card requires only a bank account.
 - (D) A credit card is issued by a bank, while a debit card is issued by a private lender.

4. Which statement explains the **main** reason that the U.S. Treasury is a part of the executive branch of federal government and the legislative branch is responsible for spending money?
- Ⓐ The separation of responsibilities creates a system of checks and balances between branches of government.
 - Ⓑ The involvement of two branches of government gives one branch more power than the other.
 - Ⓒ The involvement of two branches of government gives the third branch the authority to print money.
 - Ⓓ The separation of responsibilities makes state government responsible for printing money.

Read and study the sources about settling the western United States. Then use the four sources and your knowledge of social studies to answer questions 5–10.

Source 1



Source 2

Adapted from *The Diary of Abbie Bright* (1870–1871)

Abbie Bright, a young teacher from Pennsylvania, traveled west to visit her brother Philip in Kansas. The United States government had recently opened land in Kansas to settlers.

May 8, 1871

As soon as Philip gets to Wichita and buys supplies, we will move to his cabin. You select a claim of 160 acres, then you “file on it.” After living on it six months, and doing a certain amount of improvements, you pay \$1.25 an acre, and then it is yours.

Philip has been on his claim that long, has broken some land, and planted corn. He and some men have selected my claim, and when he goes to Wichita he will “file on it.” Then no one can file on the same land.

He selected a suitable place, and plowed it for a garden. Not having a harrow¹, he hitched the oxen to big brush and dragged it back and forth until it was well raked. I have no hoe yet, but with the help of a stick, I have managed to plant a number of seeds.

¹**harrow**: a piece of farm equipment used to plow land

Social Studies

Source 3

John Deere's Steel Plow

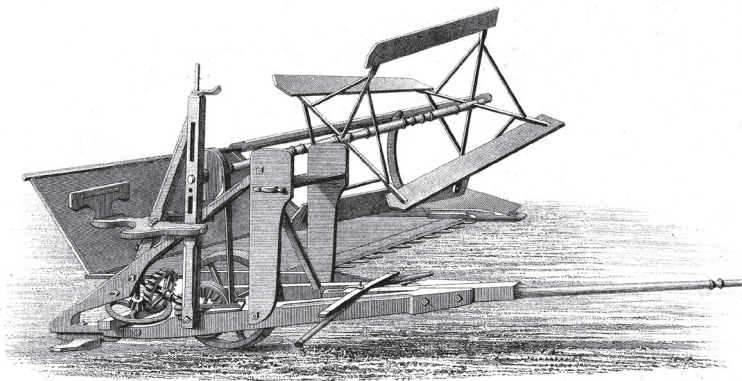
Illinois blacksmith John Deere developed the first steel plow in 1837. The steel plow was important to the success of the homesteaders on the Great Plains.



Source 4

Cyrus McCormick's Mechanical Reaper

In the 1830s, Cyrus McCormick and other American inventors improved mechanical reapers. Horses pulled these machines to harvest grains. Mechanical reapers saved people hours of work and allowed many more crops to be grown.



Source 4: Anon/Getty Images, Inc.

GO ON ►

5. Which statement **best** explains how early European explorations led to the expansion of the United States?
- Ⓐ Native Americans traded with explorers and settlers.
 - Ⓑ The government purchased the land that was explored.
 - Ⓒ People traveled more often to explore new places.
 - Ⓓ Explorers found natural resources for farming or mining.
6. Using Source 1 and Source 2, which physical feature **most likely** attracted settlers to the West?
- Ⓐ cheap land that was good for farming
 - Ⓑ giant lakes with plentiful fish
 - Ⓒ deep swamps with rich oil deposits
 - Ⓓ long coastlines that prevented foreign attacks
7. Which statement **best** describes the impact of the inventions shown in Source 3 and Source 4?
- Ⓐ They allowed people to determine which land was most fertile.
 - Ⓑ They allowed people to change the landscape to meet their needs.
 - Ⓒ They allowed people to clear land so they could build roads.
 - Ⓓ They allowed people to give their farm animals more rest.

8. How did the events in Source 1 **most likely** lead to more people settling in the West?
 - (A) The events allowed the government to force settlers to move there.
 - (B) The events encouraged settlers to travel there on vacation.
 - (C) The events allowed the country to add large amounts of land for settlers.
 - (D) The events encouraged settlers to demand independence from the government.

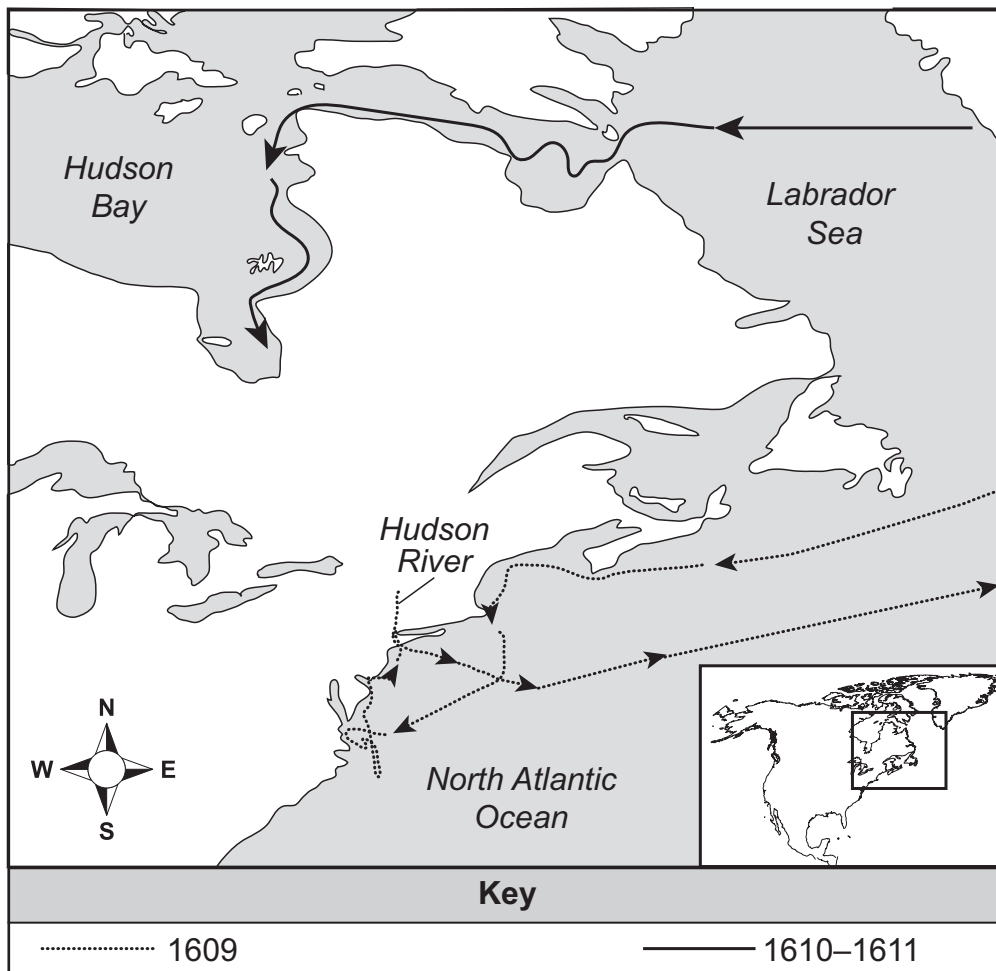
9. How did the inventions of the tools shown in Source 3 and Source 4 encourage westward migration in the United States?
 - (A) The tools made it cheaper for settlers to live.
 - (B) The tools increased the demand for ranch workers.
 - (C) The tools made it easier for settlers to establish farms.
 - (D) The tools increased the opportunities for gold miners.

10. Based on Source 2, how did the physical characteristics of Kansas **most likely** shape its economic development?
 - (A) The large amount of fertile land made farming profitable in Kansas.
 - (B) The great distances between towns made trade difficult in Kansas.
 - (C) The flat land made it easier for companies to build factories in Kansas.
 - (D) The overgrown forests encouraged timber companies to locate in Kansas.

Read and study the sources about the explorations of Henry Hudson. Then use the three sources and your knowledge of social studies to answer questions 11–15.

Source 1**Voyages of Henry Hudson (1609–1611)**

Henry Hudson was an English explorer sent to North America in 1609 by Dutch traders to find a northwest passage to China. He failed at that, but succeeded at finding and claiming new areas for Dutch colonization. He returned the following year, paid by English investors.



Source 2

Adapted from a Contract between the Dutch East India Company and Henry Hudson (1609)

The merchants of the Dutch East India Company gave special instructions about Henry Hudson's responsibilities in a contract.

The directors shall supply a small ship and provide men, supplies, and other necessities¹. Hudson shall sail to search for the Northwest Passage. He shall gain as much knowledge of the lands as can be done without much loss of time. If possible, he shall return immediately to make a complete report of his voyage to the directors. He will deliver his journals, log books, and charts, together with a report of everything that happens to him during the voyage.

¹**necessities**: things that are needed

Source 3

Henry Hudson Meeting Native Americans in New York (1609)

Henry Hudson's crew traded with, and sometimes fought, Native Americans who lived in the areas they explored. The Dutch quickly established the colony of New Netherland to take part in the fur trade with Native Americans.



Source 3: Everett Collection Historical/Alamy.

GO ON ►

11. Based on Source 1 and Source 2, what is the **most likely** reason Henry Hudson was looking for a water route to the northwestern part of North America?
- Ⓐ He was looking for a faster way to get to Asia.
 - Ⓑ He was looking for new sources of raw materials.
 - Ⓒ He wanted to establish a new colony in Asia.
 - Ⓓ He wanted to discover a new continent.
12. Based on Source 3, which statement **best** describes how Henry Hudson affected European settlement in the Americas?
- Ⓐ His explorations allowed the Dutch to settle most of the land in the Americas.
 - Ⓑ His conflicts with Native Americans created problems for Dutch settlers in the Americas.
 - Ⓒ His failure to find good land for farming made Dutch settlers lose interest in the Americas and return to Europe.
 - Ⓓ His discoveries allowed the Dutch to settle in the Americas and earn profits through trade.
13. Based on Source 1 and Source 2, what did the directors of the Dutch East India Company **mainly** hope to gain from Hudson's exploration?
- Ⓐ They hoped to establish a new settlement for access to raw materials.
 - Ⓑ They hoped to increase profits by finding an easier way to ship goods.
 - Ⓒ They hoped to become trading partners with Native Americans.
 - Ⓓ They hoped to learn about other cultures and economies.

14. Which statement **best** explains the risk taken by the company that spent money on Hudson's explorations?

- Ⓐ The company could face conflicts between explorers in the same region.
- Ⓑ The company could lose future business if the explorers got lost.
- Ⓒ The company could lose large amounts of money if the explorers failed.
- Ⓓ The company could get blamed for the behavior of the explorers they hired.

15. Describe **two** different ways that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World.

16. Use the list and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

Key Amendments to the U.S. Constitution

First Amendment—Citizens have freedom of religion, speech, and press.

Fifteenth Amendment—All male citizens have the right to vote regardless of race, color, or whether they had been enslaved.

Nineteenth Amendment—All female citizens have the right to vote.

Twenty-Fourth Amendment—Prohibits states from charging citizens a tax in order to vote.

Twenty-Sixth Amendment—Sets the national voting age at 18.

Why have these amendments been added to the U.S. Constitution since it was adopted in 1787?

- (A) to expand the rights of citizens
- (B) to ensure that all citizens vote
- (C) to identify which citizens can hold office
- (D) to define the responsibilities of citizens

17. Use the map and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

Canals and Railroads of the United States, 1830

This is one of the earliest general maps of the eastern United States showing railroads and canals in operation. The map also includes rail lines that had not been built yet.



Which statement **best** describes why the railroads and canals shown on the map were built?

- (A) People wanted easier ways to find natural resources.
- (B) People needed to find faster ways to produce goods.
- (C) People wanted faster ways to communicate across the country.
- (D) People needed easier ways to travel and transport goods.

GO ON ►

18. Use the list and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

Questions from U.S. Citizenship Test

People who want to become U.S. citizens must correctly answer six out of 10 questions about U.S. history and government. Below are some possible questions.

- What is the highest law of the land?
- What is an amendment?
- How many U.S. senators are there?
- Who is the commander in chief of the military?
- How many justices are on the Supreme Court?

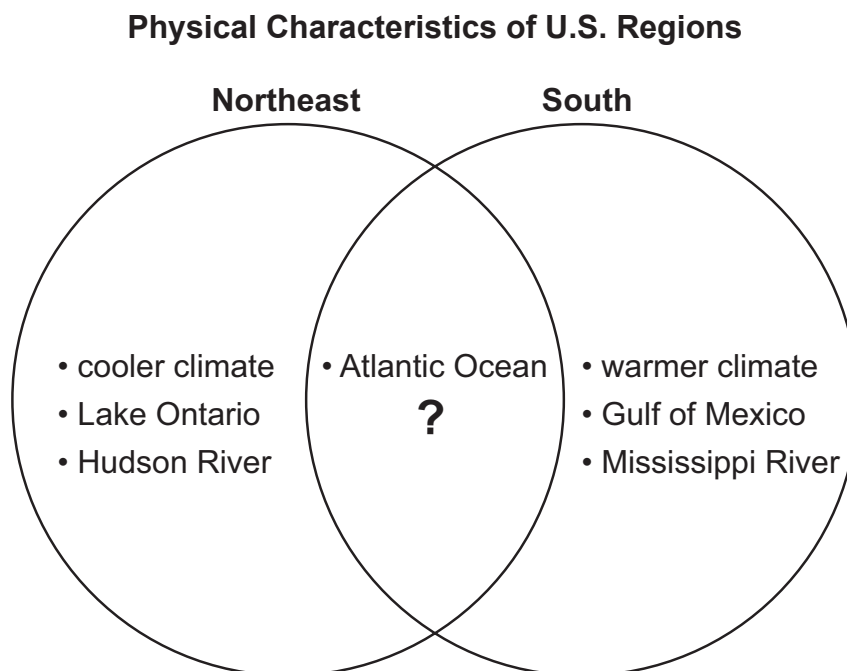
Which statement **best** describes what passing the citizenship test shows about the person taking the test?

- Ⓐ The person is likely to adjust easily to life in a new country.
- Ⓑ The person has completed all of the forms necessary for citizenship.
- Ⓒ The person knows basic facts about U.S. government and history.
- Ⓓ The person will be able to get a job to support his or her family.

19. Which statement about immigration to the United States is the **best** example of the concept of the “melting pot”?

- Ⓐ A family from Sweden moves to the United States, studies English, and adopts some U.S. customs.
- Ⓑ A young man from China moves to the United States, lives with relatives in a Chinese neighborhood, and speaks Chinese.
- Ⓒ A couple from Italy moves to the United States, speaks Italian, and practices Italian traditions.
- Ⓓ A woman from Russia moves to the United States, opens a restaurant for Russian immigrants, and serves Russian food.

20. Use the Venn diagram and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.



Which physical characteristic **best** completes the Venn diagram?

- Ⓐ Grand Canyon
- Ⓑ Everglades
- Ⓒ Great Basin
- Ⓓ Appalachian Mountains

21. Use the text and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

Making a Decision about Money

The Ortega family meets its needs each month by following a budget. This month, the family has money left over after paying bills and putting money in savings. Each child wants the family to use the extra money in a different way.

- **Gabriel:** “If you buy a new television, you can put it downstairs for us kids to watch.”
- **Sofia:** “If you buy a new bicycle for me, I can get a job delivering newspapers.”
- **Isabella:** “If you buy tickets to an amusement park, we can all have a fun time.”
- **Tomás:** “If you buy a new cell phone for me, I can text my friends.”

Which idea **most directly** benefits the most people, and why?

- (A) Gabriel’s idea, because all of the children would enjoy watching the television
- (B) Sofia’s idea, because the bicycle would allow her to earn extra money
- (C) Isabella’s idea, because the family would go to the amusement park
- (D) Tomás’s idea, because a cell phone would help him stay in contact with the family

22. Use the quotation and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

The Declaration of Independence (1776)

“We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness.”

Which statement **best** explains why the writers of the Declaration of Independence used the phrase “all men are created equal”?

- (A) They believed that people who were happy would follow orders.
- (B) They disagreed with the idea that a king should rule over all people.
- (C) They believed that all people should have the same rights regardless of their race.
- (D) They disagreed with the idea that people should make their own laws.



Session 2 Directions

Directions:

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Read each source and question. Then, follow the directions to answer each question. Mark your answers by completely filling in the circles in your test booklet. Do not make any stray pencil marks outside of the circles. If you need to change an answer, be sure to erase your first answer completely. You may look back at the sources when needed.

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Read and study the sources about the rights and responsibilities of citizenship. Then use the three sources and your knowledge of social studies to answer questions 23–28.

Source 1

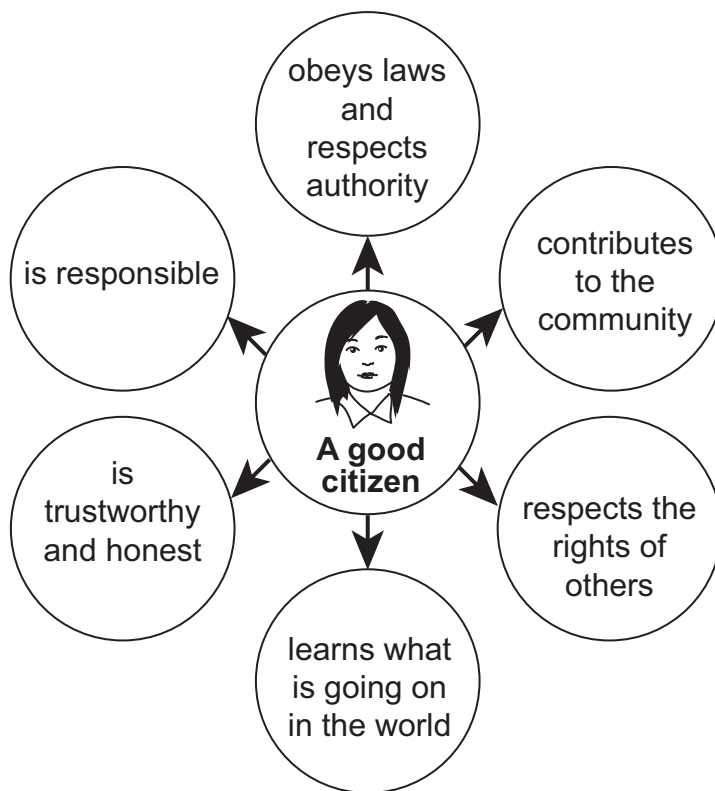
Ruby Bridges

In the photograph, Ruby Bridges stands next to a sculpture of herself as a young girl during a ceremony in 2014. The sculpture marks the day in 1960 when Bridges became the first African American to attend the all-white William Frantz Elementary School in New Orleans. Before that, black students and white students had to attend separate schools. The Supreme Court ruled this practice unconstitutional with the 1954 case of *Brown v. Board of Education*.



Source 2

Some Ways to Be a Good Citizen



Source 3

Thomas Jefferson on Citizenship (1792)

Thomas Jefferson was the main author of the Declaration of Independence and the third president of the United States. At the time of this quotation, he was serving as secretary of state under President George Washington.

“A nation, as a society, forms a moral person, and every member of it is personally responsible for his society.”

Source 1: SiliconValleyStock/Alamy.

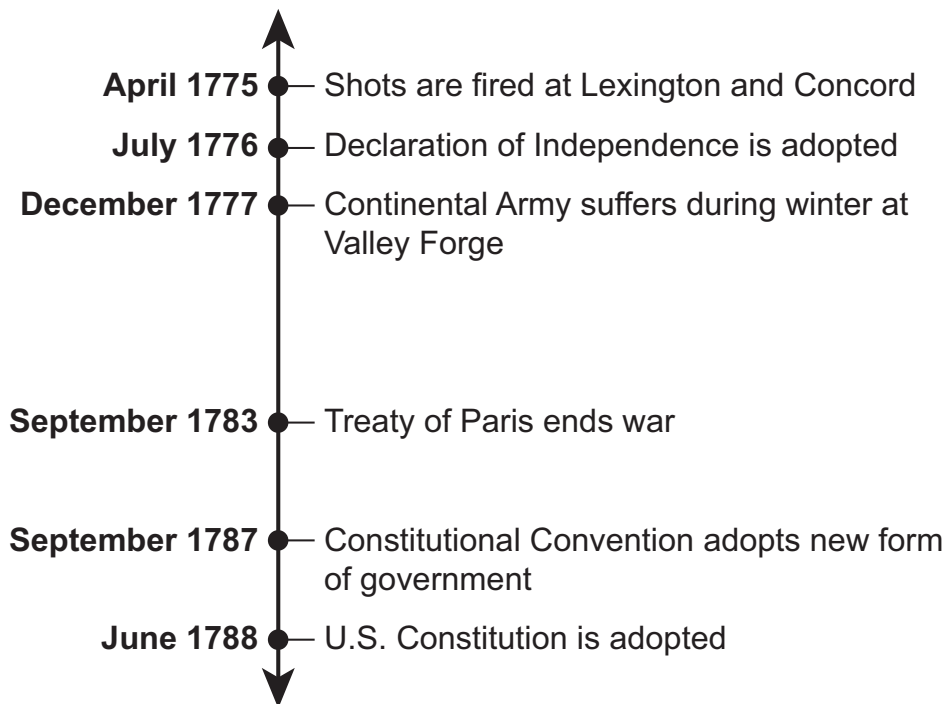
- 23.** Based on Source 1, which right did Ruby Bridges exercise in 1960?
- Ⓐ the right to worship freely
 - Ⓑ the right to run for public office
 - Ⓒ the right to equal treatment
 - Ⓓ the right to a fair trial by jury
- 24.** Based on Source 2, which statement describes a responsibility of citizenship?
- Ⓐ Citizens should learn about current events and political issues.
 - Ⓑ Citizens should take important issues to the Supreme Court.
 - Ⓒ Citizens should ignore the opinions of people they disagree with.
 - Ⓓ Citizens should vote for the candidate who is most likely to win.
- 25.** Using Source 2 and Source 3, which statements **best** describe qualities of good citizens?
- Select the **two** correct answers.
- Ⓐ They go to college.
 - Ⓑ They use their talents.
 - Ⓒ They spend money.
 - Ⓓ They vote in elections.
 - Ⓔ They volunteer their time.
 - Ⓕ They study history.

- 26.** Which statement **best** describes how good citizens contribute to the democratic process in the United States?
- Ⓐ Good citizens care for the environment.
 - Ⓑ Good citizens write to their senators to express opinions.
 - Ⓒ Good citizens create parks in neighborhoods.
 - Ⓓ Good citizens make new laws to benefit themselves.
- 27.** Which activity **best** describes an individual citizen helping to solve a current problem?
- Ⓐ Brianna learns about how people of her community are working to clean up litter at local parks.
 - Ⓑ Richard writes a report for the local newspaper, describing an important event in state history.
 - Ⓒ Michael speaks to the city council, asking them to put a stop sign at a dangerous intersection.
 - Ⓓ Gabriela visits the mayor of her town and then tells her classmates about the experience.
- 28.** Based on Source 1 and Source 3, which statement **best** describes how Ruby Bridges fulfilled Thomas Jefferson's idea of being personally responsible to society?
- Ⓐ She attended school when no one else wanted to.
 - Ⓑ She followed new laws as soon as they were made.
 - Ⓒ She took a courageous stand on an important issue.
 - Ⓓ She changed what students learned about in school.

Read and study the sources about the American Revolution and the Constitution. As you read the four sources, think about how the government created by the Founding Fathers fixed the problems they had with the British government. After you read the sources, answer questions 29–33.

Source 1

Creation of the United States of America

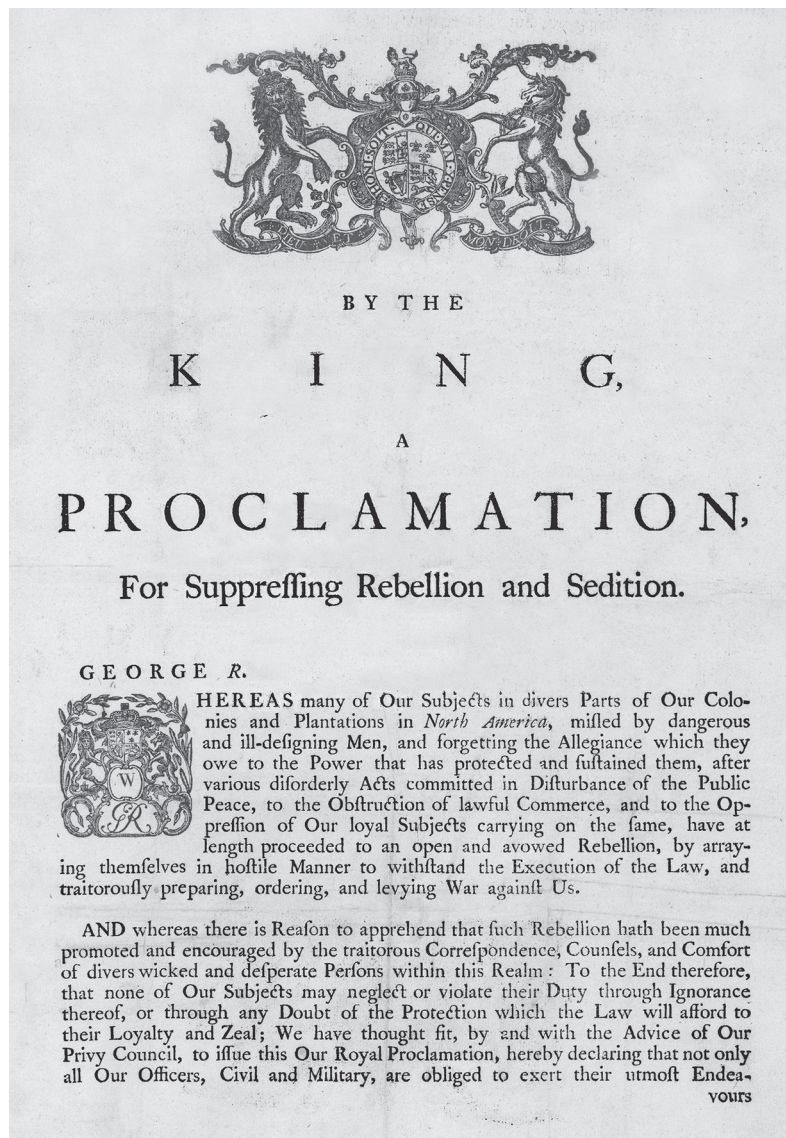


Source 2

Proclamation for Suppressing Rebellion and Sedition¹ (1775)

King George III of Great Britain issued this announcement after fighting broke out in the colonies. In the announcement, the king says that he will punish the British colonies for disobeying him. He says that he will also punish British subjects who fail to report revolutionary activity.

¹**rebellion and sedition:** actions or speech urging people to refuse to obey the government



Source 3

Signing of the U.S. Constitution, 1787

George Washington, standing in front of the flags on the right, watches over the signing of the Constitution at Independence Hall in Philadelphia. Delegate Richard Dobbs Spaight Sr. of North Carolina signs the document. Benjamin Franklin sits in the lower middle of the painting. Alexander Hamilton sits beside him. The painting, created by Howard Chandler Christy in 1940, hangs in the U.S. Capitol.



Source 4

Preamble to the U.S. Constitution (1787)

We the people of the United States, in order to form a more perfect union, establish justice, insure domestic tranquility¹, provide for the common defense, promote the general welfare, and secure the blessings of liberty to ourselves and our posterity², do ordain and establish this Constitution for the United States of America.

¹**tranquility**: peace

²**posterity**: future generations

29. Which event from Source 1 convinced King George III to issue the proclamation shown in Source 2?
- Ⓐ “Shots are fired at Lexington and Concord”
 - Ⓑ “Declaration of Independence is adopted”
 - Ⓒ “Treaty of Paris ends war”
 - Ⓓ “U.S. Constitution is adopted”
30. Which statement describes how Britain’s policies on the colonies, such as the Navigation Acts and the Molasses Act, led to the proclamation in Source 2?
- Ⓐ Colonists understood that the acts were created in their best economic interest and supported the king.
 - Ⓑ Colonists felt that the acts were imposed without representation and began to argue against them.
 - Ⓒ Colonists believed that the acts limited their ability to trade with Native Americans.
 - Ⓓ Colonists hoped that the acts would open trading opportunities with France and other nations.
31. How does Source 3 **best** show the form of government that the United States adopted with its Constitution?
- Ⓐ It shows the flags of the different colonies.
 - Ⓑ It shows people electing a king.
 - Ⓒ It shows the beginnings of a political party.
 - Ⓓ It shows representatives working for the people.

32. Which statement **best** explains the importance of the phrase “We the people” in Source 4?
- Ⓐ The phrase shows that the people, instead of politicians, could make laws for the country.
 - Ⓑ The phrase shows that people from other countries could be prevented from working in government.
 - Ⓒ The phrase shows that the people, instead of a king, would rule the new country.
 - Ⓓ The phrase shows that people would have less authority than the government.

- As you write, follow the directions below.

- [illegible]

Session 2

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



STOP

Session 3 Directions

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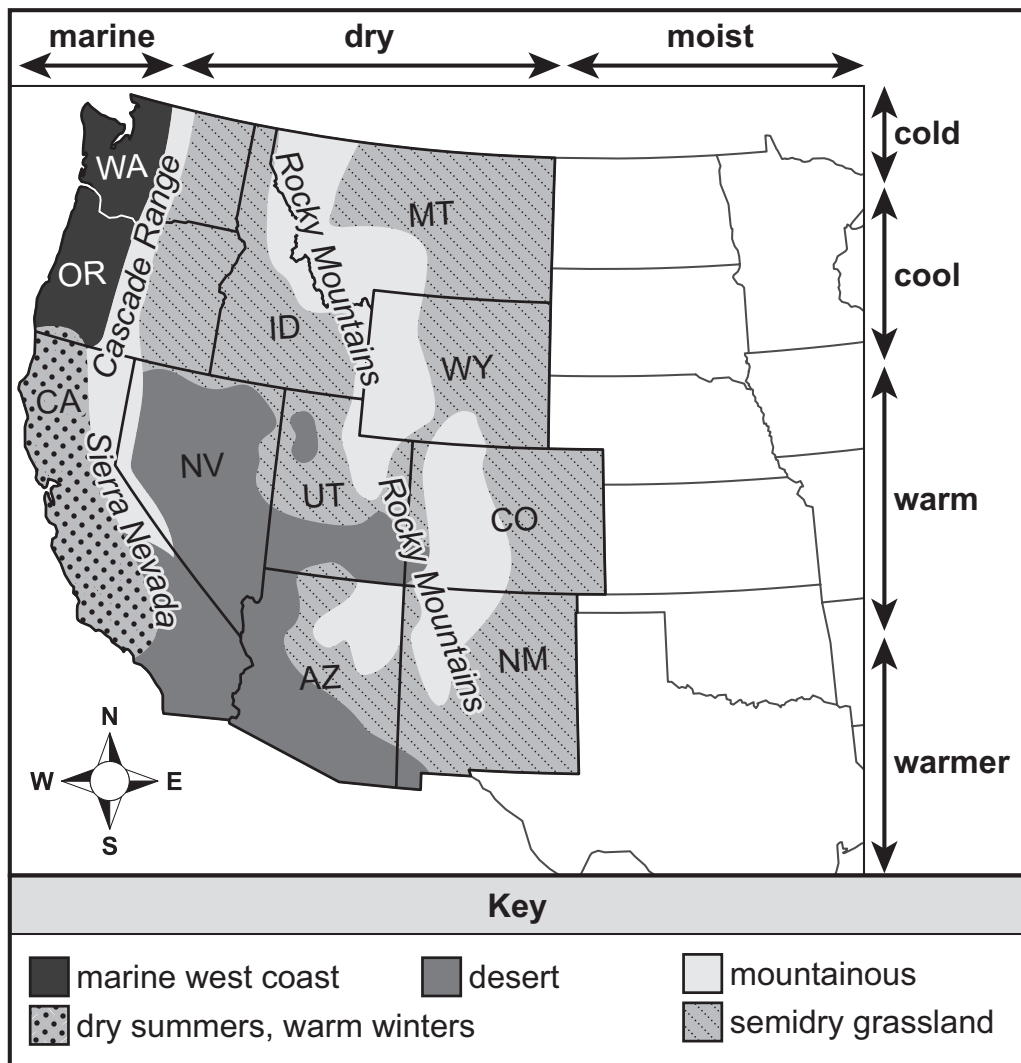
GO ON ►

Social Studies

Read and study the sources about the western United States. Then use the four sources and your knowledge of social studies to answer questions 34–39.

Source 1

Climate Zones of the Western United States



Source 2

Adapted from *Our Story**by Levi Strauss & Co.*

When news of the California Gold Rush made its way to New York, Levi Strauss traveled to San Francisco in 1853. He went there to make his fortune, though he wouldn't make it panning gold. Levi established a dry-goods business. He called his company "Levi Strauss & Co."

Levi Strauss worked with a clothing tailor named Jacob Davis. One day someone asked Jacob to make a pair of pants for workers that wouldn't fall apart. Jacob tried to think of a way to make his pants stronger. He came up with the idea to put metal rivets¹ on the pants. These pants were an instant hit. Today, these denim² pants are called "jeans."

¹**rivets**: short metal pins used to hold seams of clothing together

²**denim**: a sturdy cotton fabric

Source 3

Trans-Alaska Pipeline

The Trans-Alaska Pipeline carries oil eight hundred miles across Alaska. The oil travels from oil wells in the north to a harbor in the south. When the oil arrives in Valdez, Alaska, it is shipped to many places all over the world. Oil is important to Alaska because it brings jobs and money to the state.



Source 4

Container Ship in Seattle, Washington

Seattle, Washington, has a large port built in a natural harbor off the Pacific Ocean. Container ships transport large boxes, or containers, that hold goods. These large container ships take their cargo to and from ports all over the world.



Source 2: *Our Story*. Copyright © 2016 LS&CO. Reprinted by permission of Levi Strauss & Co. (San Francisco).

Source 4: *Journal of Commerce*.

34. Using Source 1, which state has the **best** weather for growing citrus crops?
- Ⓐ Idaho
 - Ⓑ California
 - Ⓒ Montana
 - Ⓓ Utah
35. Using Source 1, which statement **best** explains why Nevada has fewer people than the California coast?
- Ⓐ Nevada is too rainy.
 - Ⓑ Nevada is mostly desert.
 - Ⓒ Nevada has too few mountains.
 - Ⓓ Nevada has only one climate zone.
36. Based on Source 2, how did Levi Strauss use natural resources to produce goods?
- Select the **two** correct answers.
- Ⓐ He used lumber to make packages for his clothing.
 - Ⓑ He used copper to make dyes to color his clothing.
 - Ⓒ He used fabric made from cotton for his clothing.
 - Ⓓ He used oil to run the trains that delivered his clothing.
 - Ⓔ He used metal to make rivets to strengthen his clothing.
 - Ⓕ He used beaver fur to line the pockets of his clothing.

37. Which statement **best** describes how a natural resource is used to provide the transportation services shown in Source 4?
- Ⓐ Land is used to grow food for the people who move goods.
 - Ⓑ Lumber is used to make paper for the trader who moves goods.
 - Ⓒ Water is used to provide the power that moves goods.
 - Ⓓ Metal is used to build the devices that move goods.
38. Based on Source 4, which physical feature makes Seattle important to world trade?
- Ⓐ a deep natural harbor for large ships
 - Ⓑ a supply of metal to make containers
 - Ⓒ a large supply of fish and seafood
 - Ⓓ a river that has large natural levees
39. Which statement **best** describes how the geography of the West affected its early settlement and economic development?
- Ⓐ The dry, arid air made establishing farms difficult, so settlers focused on manufacturing in Nevada deserts.
 - Ⓑ The fertile soil allowed settlers to establish large homesteads and turn the West into the nation's breadbasket.
 - Ⓒ The large ocean allowed settlers to earn a prosperous living by fishing off the coast of California.
 - Ⓓ The mountains and deserts made it difficult for early settlers to reach the West as they moved to find gold and other natural resources.

Read and study the sources about the iron and steel industry. Then use the three sources and your knowledge of social studies to answer questions 40–44.

Source 1

Adapted from *William Kelly*

by Arshad Mahmud

Inventor William Kelly (1811–1888) developed a process that made steel stronger and cheaper. Steel became the most important construction material of the Industrial Revolution.

Kelly succeeded in producing iron and steel with his newly developed process. The quality of the steel was still largely uncertain. He did not patent¹ the process immediately, but continued working on it.

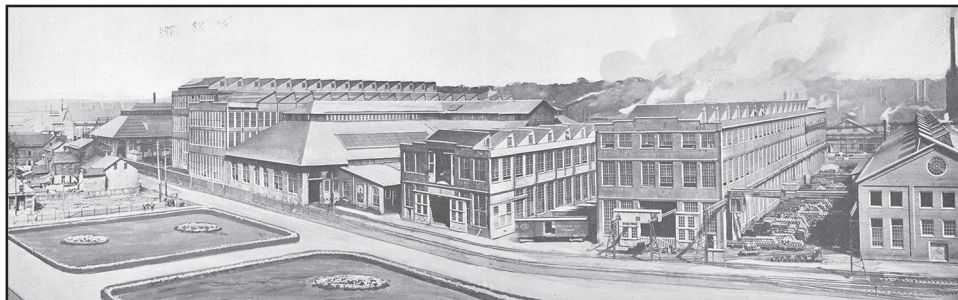
In 1856, Henry Bessemer patented a similar process and was applying for a patent in the United States. Bessemer was trying to make stronger steel and had proved his method a success. In 1857, Kelly was also granted a patent for his process.

¹**patent:** apply for an official government document giving an inventor the right to make, use, or sell an invention

Source 2

Bethlehem Steel Works, Pennsylvania (1912)

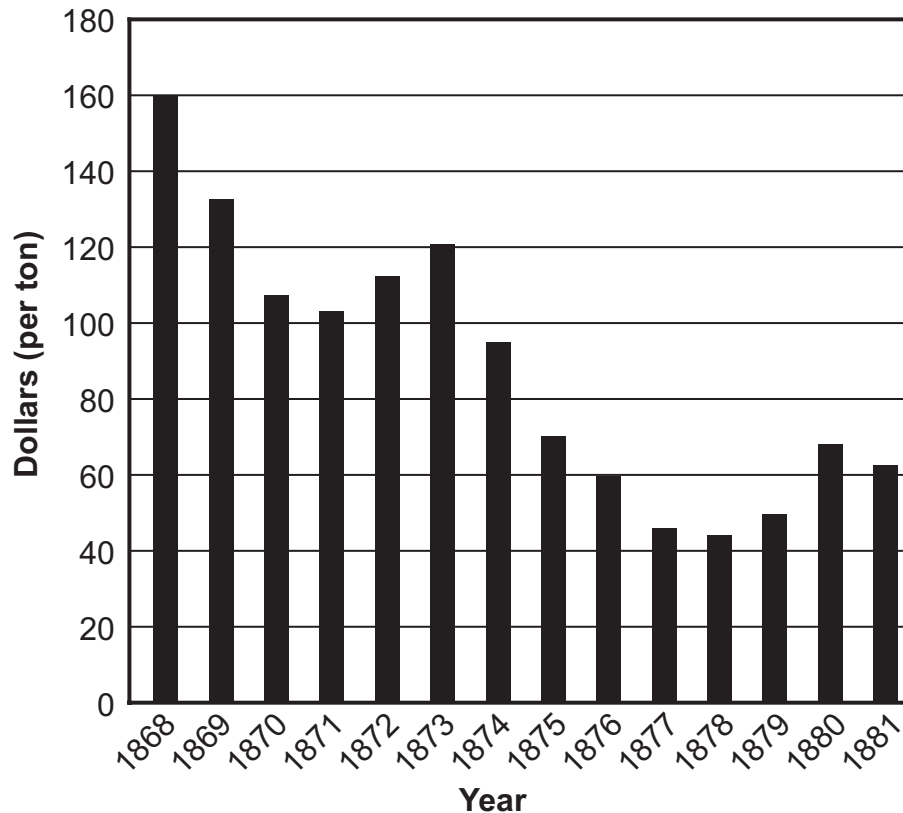
Bethlehem Steel was an iron company established in 1857. It became the second largest steel producer in the United States. Steel from the Bethlehem mills was used to build ships and skyscrapers. Steel mills were located near waterways and railroad lines. This made it easier to transport natural resources and finished products.



Source 3

U.S. Steel Production, 1868–1881

The processes developed by William Kelly and Henry Bessemer affected the amount of steel produced in the United States between 1868 and 1881. During this period, steel was used mostly to make steel rails for railroads. The graph shows the effect of production on the price of steel rails.



Source 1: *William Kelly* by Arshad Mahmud. Copyright © 2012 The American Society of Mechanical Engineers. Reprinted courtesy of ASME.

40. Which statement explains the **most likely** reason that the steel company built its plant in Bethlehem, Pennsylvania, as shown in Source 2?
- Ⓐ Bethlehem was a small town with no competing industries.
 - Ⓑ Bethlehem was close enough to access the necessary raw materials.
 - Ⓒ Bethlehem had a large population of people looking for work.
 - Ⓓ Bethlehem had lower wages than other similarly sized cities.
41. Using Source 1 and Source 3, which statement **best** explains how Kelly's and Bessemer's improvements in iron production also helped other industries?
- Ⓐ The falling price of steel rails allowed railroad companies to expand.
 - Ⓑ The new process made it necessary to build additional worker housing.
 - Ⓒ The new process required more workers to mine raw materials.
 - Ⓓ The falling price of steel led to the creation of labor unions.
42. Using the sources, how did the changes in steel production affect the lives of average people?
- Select the **two** correct answers.
- Ⓐ Transportation costs increased.
 - Ⓑ Workers had more free time.
 - Ⓒ People traveled by train to more places.
 - Ⓓ Land became more valuable.
 - Ⓔ Construction jobs increased.
 - Ⓕ Pollution from factories decreased.

- 43.** How did improvements in steel production affect the price of steel rails, as shown in Source 3?
- Ⓐ New technologies made steel rails stronger while increasing their cost.
 - Ⓑ New technologies decreased the demand for workers, which decreased the cost of steel rails.
 - Ⓒ New technologies decreased the amount of iron on the market, which increased the cost of steel rails.
 - Ⓓ New technologies allowed workers to produce steel rails at a lower cost.

- 44.** Describe **one** way that improvements in steel production affected human resources and **one** way that improvements in steel production affected natural resources.

45. Use the picture and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

Betsy Ross (1777)

by J. L. G. Ferris

The picture shows Betsy Ross explaining to John Ross and Robert Morris how she made an American flag. George Washington sits in the chair to the left.

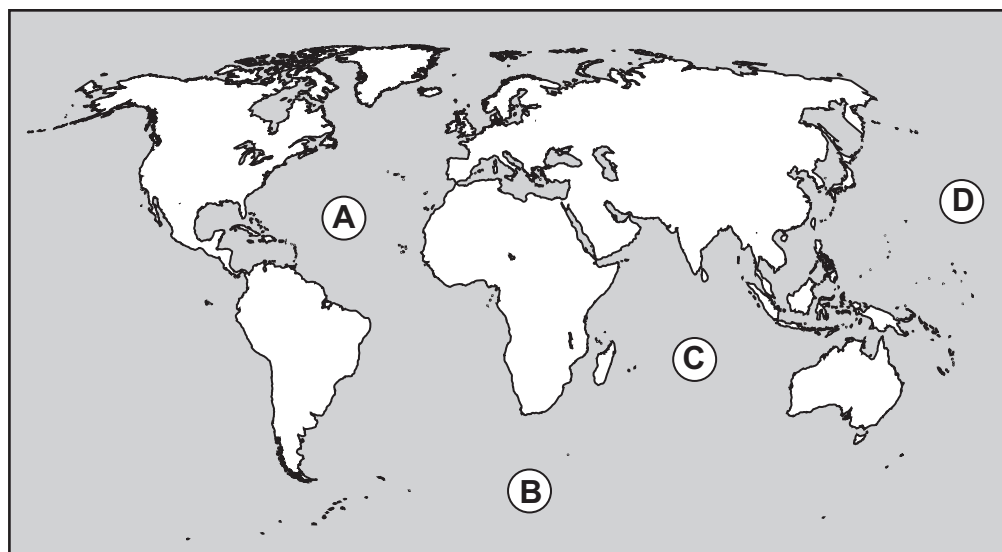


Which statement **best** describes the significance of the changes in the United States flag?

- (A) Colors have been changed to match the Great Seal of the United States.
- (B) Stars have been added as states have been admitted into the Union.
- (C) Stripes have been added as the Constitution has been amended.
- (D) The size has been changed as the population of the United States has grown.

46. Use the map and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

Oceans of the World



Which letter on the map shows the location of the Indian Ocean?

- Ⓐ letter A
- Ⓑ letter B
- Ⓒ letter C
- Ⓓ letter D

47. Use the map and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

The Oregon Trail



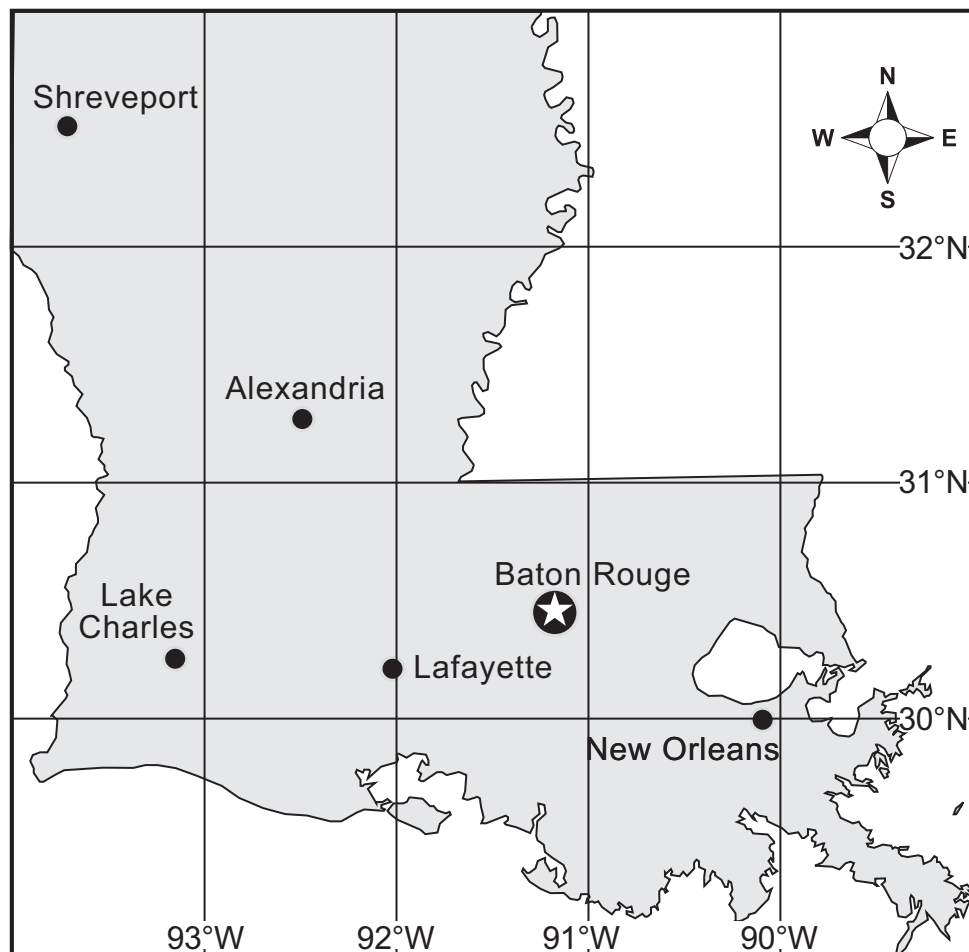
Which geographic feature made the journey on the Oregon Trail difficult for settlers?

- Ⓐ Rocky Mountains
- Ⓑ Niagara Falls
- Ⓒ Mississippi River
- Ⓓ Death Valley

48. Use the map and your knowledge of social studies to answer the question.

Latitude and Longitude in Louisiana

The map shows latitude and longitude lines in Louisiana.



Which city in Louisiana is located closest to 30°N and 93°W?

- Ⓐ Lafayette
- Ⓑ New Orleans
- Ⓒ Lake Charles
- Ⓓ Baton Rouge

STOP

This document contains the answer keys, rubrics, and Scoring Notes for items on the Grade 4 Social Studies Practice Test. Refer to the [Practice Test Library](#) for additional resources, including the [Social Studies Practice Test Guidance](#), which provides general supports and cautions in using the practice test, and the [Annotated Social Studies Practice Test Items](#) document, which explains the purpose and reasoning of selected practice tests items. For additional help in scoring constructed- and extended-response items, refer to the [2019 Summit Session: Social Studies 101](#) materials and presentation.

Session	Set	Sequence	Item Type	Key	Alignment
1	Wants, Needs, and Money	1	MC	D	4.9.7 Explain why individuals and businesses engage in barter and trade
1		2	MC	C	4.9.7 Explain why individuals and businesses engage in barter and trade
1		3	MC	B	4.9.8 Differentiate between money (currency), checks, debit cards, and credit cards and identify advantages and disadvantages of each type of monetary exchange
1		4	MC	A	4.7.4 Differentiate between the structure and function of the three branches of federal government
1	Settling the West	5	MC	D	4.2.1 Explain how early explorations affected the expansion of boundaries and development in the United States
1		6	MC	A	4.5.3 Identify and explain how the physical characteristics of a region influenced human settlement
1		7	MC	B	4.6.2 Describe the human impact on the land and bodies of water of the five regions of the United States
1		8	MC	C	4.1.2 Use timelines to explain how changes over time have caused movement of people or expansion of boundaries in the United States
1		9	MC	C	4.3.1 Explain how inventions and new processes affected the lives of people, migration, and the economy of regions of the United States
1		10	MC	A	4.5.2 Analyze how physical characteristics of a region shape its economic development

Session	Set	Sequence	Item Type	Key	Alignment
1	Henry Hudson and the Dutch East India Company	11	MC	A	4.2.1 Explain how early explorations affected the expansion of boundaries and development in the United States
1		12	MC	D	4.2.2 Cite evidence to support the key contributions and influence of people in the history of the United States
1		13	MC	B	4.9.7 Explain why individuals and businesses engage in barter and trade
1		14	MC	C	4.9.3 Define the terms <i>profit</i> and <i>risk</i> and explain how they relate to each other
1		15	CR	see rubric	4.2.1 Explain how early explorations affected the expansion of boundaries and development in the United States
1	Standalone Items	16	MC	A	4.7.1 Identify and summarize significant changes that have been made to the United States Constitution through the amendment process
1		17	MC	D	4.6.2 Describe the human impact on the land and bodies of water of the five regions of the United States
1		18	MC	C	4.8.1 Identify the key requirements to become a United States citizen
1		19	MC	A	4.2.5 Use the concepts “melting pot,” “salad bowl,” and “cultural mosaic” to explain the impact of immigration on population growth and diversity in the United States
1		20	MC	D	4.5.1 Compare and contrast the distinguishing physical characteristics of the five regions of the United States
1		21	MC	C	4.9.1 Develop a logical argument to support the choice of a particular want after all needs are met
1		22	MC	B	4.7.2 Explain the significance of key ideas contained in the Declaration of Independence, the United States Constitution, and the Bill of Rights

Session	Set	Sequence	Item Type	Key	Alignment
2	Individual Rights and Responsibilities	23	MC	C	4.8.2 Differentiate between citizens' rights, responsibilities, and duties
2		24	MC	A	4.8.2 Differentiate between citizens' rights, responsibilities, and duties
2		25	MS	D, E	4.8.3 Describe the qualities of a good citizen and how good citizenship contributes to the United States' democracy
2		26	MC	B	4.8.3 Describe the qualities of a good citizen and how good citizenship contributes to the United States' democracy
2		27	MC	C	4.8.4 Explain how good citizenship can solve a current issue
2		28	MC	C	4.8.2 Differentiate between citizens' rights, responsibilities, and duties
2	The American Revolution and the Constitution	29	MC	A	4.1.1 Construct timelines of historical events
2		30	MC	B	4.2.4 Draw conclusions about the relationship of significant events in the history of the United States to the expansion of democracy in the United States
2		31	MC	D	4.2.4 Draw conclusions about the relationship of significant events in the history of the United States to the expansion of democracy in the United States
2		32	MC	C	4.7.3 Identify and analyze the basic purposes and necessity of government as identified in the Preamble to the United States Constitution
2		33	ER	see rubric	4.7.2 Explain the significance of key ideas contained in the Declaration of Independence, the United States Constitution, and the Bill of Rights
3	U.S. Regions: The West	34	MC	B	4.5.2 Analyze how physical characteristics of a region shape its economic development
3		35	MC	B	4.5.3 Identify and explain how the physical characteristics of a region influenced human settlement
3		36	MS	C, E	4.9.2 Identify examples of human, natural, and capital resources and explain how these resources are used to produce goods and provide services
3		37	MC	D	4.9.2 Identify examples of human, natural, and capital resources and explain how these resources are used to produce goods and provide services
3		38	MC	A	4.5.2 Analyze how physical characteristics of a region shape its economic development
3		39	MC	D	4.5.3 Identify and explain how the physical characteristics of a region influenced human settlement

Session	Set	Sequence	Item Type	Key	Alignment
3	The Iron and Steel Industry	40	MC	B	4.5.2 Analyze how physical characteristics of a region shape its economic development
3		41	MC	A	4.2.2 Cite evidence to support the key contributions and influence of people in the history of the United States
3		42	MS	C, E	4.3.1 Explain how inventions and new processes affected the lives of people, migration, and the economy of regions of the United States
3		43	MC	D	4.9.4 Investigate the relationship between supply, demand, and price
3		44	CR	see rubric	4.9.2 Identify examples of human, natural, and capital resources and explain how these resources are used to produce goods and provide services
3	Standalone Items	45	MC	B	4.1.5 Explain the historical significance of U.S. political symbols
3		46	MC	C	4.4.1 Locate and label continents, oceans, the poles, hemispheres, and key parallels and meridians on a map and globe
3		47	MC	A	4.5.1 Compare and contrast the distinguishing physical characteristics of the five regions of the United States
3		48	MC	C	4.4.5 Determine the approximate longitude and latitude coordinates of various locations in the United States

Session 1 Item 15

Describe **two** different ways that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World.

Scoring Information	
Score Points	Description
2	Student's response correctly describes two different ways that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World.
1	Student's response correctly describes one way that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World.
0	Student's response does not correctly describe a way that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World. OR Student's response is blank, irrelevant, or too brief to evaluate.

Scoring Notes:

Ways that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World:

- Explorers discovered new lands for Europeans to settle.
- Explorers wrote descriptions of the New World, which made Europeans want to know more about it.
- Explorers brought back reports of the many natural resources in the New World.
- Explorers showed that there was money to be made in the New World by trading with Native Americans.
- Explorers proved that settlement in the New World was possible.
- Explorers made people excited about exploration and eager to start their own explorations and adventures.

Accept other reasonable responses.

Student Responses for Session 1 Item 15

Prompt

Describe **two** different ways that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World.

Response 1

A way explores like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World is the trade with indians and how much money they could recieve by trading common items for really valuble like fur. Henry Hudson fur traded with the Indians and many people found out and wanted to be rich because I know fur was very valuble in Europe. Another reason is how the explores discovered the East coast and how that was a very good place to settle, start a buissness, and transport many items. People could easily transport goods common in Europe for things valuble in place like Asia. People would want to catch fish and start a fishing buissness or maybe a ship building buissness. It would be a great place to settle for a water source. Those are two reasons why explores made people want to settle to the New World.

Score: 2

The response earns a strong 2. It correctly, fully, and completely addresses the prompt. For the first example, the response connects the economic benefit for establishing a fur trade in North America with Hudson’s exploration. For the second example, the response describes in detail the economic benefits of settlement on the East Coast for an immigrant, such as being able to “transport many items” or “start a fishing buissness.”

Response 2

One way that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World is telling them about trade there. Henry Hudson's crew traded with the Native Americans. They traded fur, and other goods. When they returned home, they most likely told their family and friends about the trade, and encouraged them to move there. Another way explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World was telling them there was land. Henry Hudson was trying to find a water route, but failed. Instead, he found land. Dutch claimed the land, and there was enough for everyone to establish a home, farm, and more.

Score: 2

The response earns a 2. It correctly, fully, and completely describes two ways—the fur trade and discovery of land for settlement—that explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged Europeans to immigrate to North America.

Response 3

Explorers like Henry Hudson encouraged the Europeans to immigrate to the new world because of the discoveries the explorers made so if they discovered a lot of good land for them to farm on then they would come to the new world because it would make it easier for the farmers and people who work on farms and it would be a lot better also. Another thing that encouraged the Europeans to immigrate in the new world is the cheapness of claiming new land such as if it was the Europeans fighting for new land with another group to claim good land they would rush to the new world to get that land first and it only cost 1.25 per acre.

Score: 1

The response earns a 1. It only addresses one way that explorers encouraged immigration: discovery of “good land” and “new land” for developing farms. Evidence and details all relate to the idea of gaining land and developing farms. The response would need another, distinctly different way in order to earn a score of 2.

Response 4

Hudson had discovered Hudson Bay, and Hudson River. He encouraged Europeans to immigrate to the New World because he had found new places. And that is why he encouraged them to go to the New World.

Score: 1

The response earns a low 1. The response identifies one way that explorers encouraged immigration: “found new places.” Although it is limited, it is enough to earn a score of 1.

Response 5

1. Henry Hudson could have made them want to travel and explore new things. 2. Henry could have encouraged them to want to make other people want to go.

Score: 0

The response earns a 0. The two sentences offered as reasons are general statements that rephrase the prompt. The response provides no new information or explanation of ways exploration “encouraged them” “to travel and explore.”

Session 2 Item 33

Based on the sources and your knowledge of social studies, explain how the government created by the Founding Fathers fixed the problems they had with the British government.

As you write, follow the directions below.

- Address all parts of the prompt.
- Include information and examples from your own knowledge of social studies.
- Use evidence from the sources to support your response.

Scoring

The response should be scored **holistically** on its adherence to two dimensions: Content and Claims. Each response should be given the score that corresponds to the set of bulleted descriptors that **best** describes the response.

Dimension: Content	
Score	Description
4	The student's response: - Reflects thorough knowledge of how the government created by the Founding Fathers fixed the problems they had with the British government, by incorporating ample, focused factual information from prior knowledge and the sources; - Contains accurate understandings with no errors significant enough to detract from the overall content of the response; - Fully addresses all parts of the prompt.
3	The student's response: - Reflects general knowledge of how the government created by the Founding Fathers fixed the problems they had with the British government, by incorporating adequate factual information from prior knowledge and the sources; - Contains mostly accurate understandings with minimal errors that do not substantially detract from the overall content of the response; - Addresses all parts of the prompt.
2	The student's response: - Reflects limited knowledge of how the government created by the Founding Fathers fixed the problems they had with the British government, by incorporating some factual information from prior knowledge and the sources; - Contains some accurate understandings with a few errors that detract from the overall content of the response; - Addresses part of the prompt.
1	The student's response: - Reflects minimal knowledge of how the government created by the Founding Fathers fixed the problems they had with the British government, by incorporating little or no factual information from prior knowledge and the sources; - Contains few accurate understandings with several errors that detract from the overall content of the response; - Minimally addresses part of the prompt.
0	The student's response is blank, incorrect, or does not address the prompt.

Dimension: Claims	
Score	Description
4	- The student's response: - Develops a valid claim that effectively expresses a solid understanding of the topic; - Thoroughly supports the claim with well-chosen evidence from the sources; - Provides a logically organized, cohesive, and in-depth explanation of the connections, patterns, and trends among ideas, people, events, and/or contexts within or across time and place.
3	- The student's response: - Develops a relevant claim that expresses a general understanding of the topic; - Supports the claim with sufficient evidence from the sources; - Provides an organized explanation of the connections, patterns, and trends among ideas, people, events, and/or contexts within or across time and place.
2	- The student's response: - Presents a claim that expresses a basic understanding of the topic; - Includes limited support for the claim by using some evidence from the sources; - Provides a weak explanation of the connections, patterns, and trends among ideas, people, events, and/or contexts within or across time and place.
1	- The student's response: - Presents a claim with little or no evidence from the sources; - Provides a vague, unclear, or illogical explanation of the connections among ideas, people, events, and/or contexts within or across time and place.
0	The student's response is blank, incorrect, too brief to evaluate, or lacks a claim that addresses the prompt.

Characteristics of a Strong Response

A strong response is logically organized into several paragraphs. Any errors in spelling, punctuation, grammar, or capitalization do not interfere with the ability of the reader to understand the ideas presented.

A strong response may develop one or more lines of reasoning to support the claim. Here are some examples.

- The Founding Fathers did not like being under the rule of a king, so they created a government that had power spread among many people.
- The Founding Fathers felt that the monarchy had too much power with no limitations, so they created a system of government with checks and balances.
- The Founding Fathers felt that their basic rights were being infringed upon by the king's proclamations and wanted to be able to have a voice in government.
- The Founding Fathers felt as though the decisions made by the monarchy were in the best interest of the king, rather than the best interest of the colonies. They wanted to create a government that was in their best interest.

A strong response shows understanding of the topic by analyzing the required sources and including well-chosen evidence from the sources, such as:

- The Founding Fathers faced a difficult war to have a new government (Source 1).
- The proclamation shows that King George III could punish the colonies and the colonists without a trial or other legal protections, which led the new country to clearly define the goal of protecting liberty (Source 2).
- The painting of the signing of the Constitution shows that one goal of the federal government is to act in the name of the people (Source 3).
- Phrases in the preamble reflect the values and aspects of the government that the Founding Fathers were creating (Source 4):
 - "We the people" is to act on behalf of the people.
 - "To form a more perfect union" is to improve the country.
 - "Establish justice" is to create fair laws and courts.
 - "Insure domestic tranquility" is to guarantee peace.
 - "Provide for the common defense" is to protect the country from harm.

- “Promote the general welfare” is to encourage the well-being of all people.
- “Secure the blessings of liberty to ourselves and our posterity” is to ensure freedom for Americans now and in the future.

A strong response also includes important information beyond what is presented in the sources, such as:

- The legislative branch includes the Senate and the House of Representatives and is charged with making the laws for everyone in the country. The executive branch includes the president and is charged with making sure that the laws are enforced. The judicial branch includes the courts, which help to make sure the laws are fair and conform to the Constitution.
- State legislatures and Congress are made up of representatives and senators, who act on behalf of the people.
- Previously, the colonies were ruled by foreign governments, which did not always act for the good of the people. Even the Articles of Confederation contained flaws, so people wanted to create a new form of government with the Constitution.

Student Responses for Session 2 Item 33**Response 1**

The government created by the Founding Farrthers fixed the problems they had by establishins fair law based rules. According to the source 4, the preamble to the U.S. Constitution 1787 it talks about how all people should have liberty and all should have the same fair rights which King Geogre did not want to provide. Based on what I learned, King Geogre had unfair rules and lots of taxes people had to pay and follow and they couldnt vote on some of these rules but when the Founding Farrthers create the new government Geogre Washinton he was the first president he had fair laws and rules. The people got to vote on rules and taxes and got rights As you can see, the government create by the Founding Farrthers fixed the problems they had estabilishing fair law based rules.

Score 3 Content, 4 Claims

The response supports all parts of the prompt. It includes a valid claim (“fixed the problems they had by establishins fair law based rules”), which is supported with general evidence from the sources, logical connections, but limited prior knowledge. To earn a 4 in content, more specific information to elaborate on “unfair rules,” “fair rights, and “lots of taxes” would need to be included. The response is fairly well organized, and the minor errors in spelling are not enough to detract from the overall meaning.

Response 2

From my knowledge of social studies I know that the government made by the Founding Fathers fixes the problems they had with the British by not following their laws and going against everything in Britiain. They started the Boston Tea Party because of tea taxes because Britain spent a lot of money in war so the peoplehad to payback the taxes. There wer so many acts the British were apposing on them such as he intolerable act and the quartering act and many more. In the story a problem the Founding Fathers solved they had with the british government was in source 2 in the proclamation written by the king where it says after disorderly acts committed in in disturbance of the public peace. So i mad we were just standing up for our freedom and he know we were going against the acts so thye wrote the Constiution.

Score 3 Content, 3 Claims

The response addresses all parts of the prompt and includes a relevant claim that expresses a general understanding of the topic (“by not following their laws and going against everything”). Specific connections are made to support the claim with general evidence describing the Boston Tea Party and the Intolerable Acts leading up to the writing of the Constitution. The response contains accurate understandings and is generally presented in an organized manner. Errors in grammar and spelling are not substantial enough to detract from meaning.

Response 3

The government created by the Founding Farthers fixed the promblems they had with the Bristish goverment because they created the declaration. For example the founding farthers wrots the declaration to free the colonists from the british and form a new union away from the british and establish jutice and freedom. For example the passage says “We the people of the u.s., in order to form a perfect union,establish justice,insure domestic tranquility.” This means the colonists wished for a new nation and the founding faryhers wanted one too so they created the declaration to freee them and give them the right to vote there own government they want, that they think will go good for them.They wanted George Washington to be there new king but he said he think they should just have presidents instead.so the founding farthers created there new nation by writing the declaration to free the people from the king and they foxed the problem by writing the declaration of indepedence so thwy could have there own untion so they don’t have deal with all the taxes and the hard things they are putting on the colonists to pay up and they also wrote the declaration of idependece for their civil right over them.

Score 2 Content, 2 Claims

The response presents a claim that expresses a basic understanding of the topic (“fixed the promblems they had with the Bristish goverment because they created the declaration”). Support for the claim is limited as it is presented through quoted material from the source, supported with weak connections (“This means the colonists wished for a new nation and the founding faryhers wanted one too.”). Some misinterpreted information is used to support the claim (“created there new nation by writing the declaration”). Overall the response presents a limited knowledge of the topic with mostly accurate understandings while the general misunderstanding is enough to detract from the overall content.

Response 4

The government wanted to make a stand. This is the true story. So, the government had problems with British taxes. It was breaking the law because it was taxation without representation. So, the government rebelled. It was a cruel and bloody fight between the British and the colonists. I think the war lasted about five year.

Score 1 Content, 1 Claims

The response presents a claim (“**The government wanted to make a stand.**”) which expresses a minimal understanding of the topic. There is insufficient support for the claim using little or incorrect factual information from the sources and prior knowledge (“**So, the government had problems with British taxes. It was breaking the law because it was taxation without representation**”). The response does not fully address the prompt, only stating that the “government had problems with the British taxes” rather than the colonist establishing a new form of government.

Response 5

Do you know how the government by the Founding Fathers fixed the problem with the British government? If you don't I will tell you. The way they fixed the the problem was that they agreed and signed the amendments, Declaration of Independence, and the Constitution.

They did this because the British government was unfair, they were unfair by them taxing everyone without them knowing. That's how they solved the problem.

In conclusion the British got what they deserved. All because of the government created by the Founding Fathers, The text states this in Source 2. that's the end of my essay.

Score 1 (low) Content, 0 Claims

The response attempts to develop a claim at the beginning, but fails to addresses the prompt, and provides little evidence to support (“The way they fixed the the problem was that they agreed and signed the amendments, Declaration of Independence, and the Constitution.”). Minimal understanding of the topic is presented (“the British government was unfair, they were unfair by them taxing everyone”), and some information (“without them knowing”) is inaccurate. Supporting information from the source is inadequate to further develop the response worthy of earning a higher score (“The text states this in Source 2.”).

Response 6

George washington ,standing in front of the flags on the right,watches over the signing of the constitution at independence hall in philadelphia

Score 0 Content, 0 Claims

The response does not earn credit for the Content or Claims rubric because it is copied information from the source without any additional information or explanation presented.

Session 3 Item 44

Describe **one** way that improvements in steel production affected human resources and **one** way that improvements in steel production affected natural resources.

Scoring Information	
Score Points	Description
2	Student's response correctly describes one way that improvements in steel production affected human resources and one way that improvements in steel production affected natural resources.
1	Student's response correctly describes one way that improvements in steel production affected human resources or one way that improvements in steel production affected natural resources.
0	Student's response does not describe how improvements in steel production affected either human resources or natural resources. OR Student's response is blank, irrelevant, or too brief to evaluate.

Scoring Notes:

Ways improvements in steel production affected human resources:

- Workers had to learn new skills in order to keep working in the steel industry.
- Increased steel production led to increased demand for the workers who were needed to produce steel and to make a wide range of products that use steel.

Ways improvements in steel production affected natural resources:

- Improvements in steel production allowed mills to make steel faster and cheaper than before. As a result, railroad companies could build more tracks, which increased the demand for natural resources such as the iron used to make steel.
- Improvements in steel production led to increased construction of new buildings, ships, and railroads, placing a greater demand on natural resources such as wood and the materials used to make concrete.
- Improvements in steel production resulted in stronger ships, which allowed companies to ship more materials and products over greater distances. This established new markets for goods, which increased the demand for the natural resources used to make those goods.

Accept other reasonable responses.

Student Responses for Session 3 Item 44

Describe **one** way that improvements in steel production affected human resources and **one** way that improvements in steel production affected natural resources.

Response 1

One way that improvment in steel production affected human resources was that it provided jobs for people but, it used up molten iron. One way that improvments in steel effected natrual resources was that trees were being cut down for more buildings and animals were losing homes. I know this because it came from my knoladge. A lot of steel was made so lots of iron was used.

Score: 2

The response earns a high 2. It correctly describes how improvements affected human resources (“provided jobs for people”) and natural resources (“trees were being cut down”). It provides evidence from Source 1 and makes connections to support the response.

Response 2

One way the steel production afected the human resources is it took more people to build the railroads that the indistre built out of the steel. One way the steel production afected the natrual resources is people started to use steel instead of wood.

Score: 2

The response earns a 2. It minimally but accurately describes the effects on both human resources (“it took more people to build the railroads”) and natural resources (“use steel instead of wood”).

Response 3

Steel Productions improvements affected human resources because they are using steel. Since they are using steel, they are lowering the amounts of steel to make skyscrapers and ships and rails for trains. They also make steel mills by waterways and railroad tracks to make it easier to transport goods. Steel Productions improvements affect natural resources because the people are breaking the ground to place the railroad tracks. The people are also cutting down trees to make the rails. Finally, the people are cutting down the trees to make the Steel Mills.

Score: 1

The response earns a high 1. The response accurately and completely describes the effect on natural resources (“cutting down the trees”), but it does not clearly connect the effect on human resources with “using steel.” The response is missing a connection to jobs or employment, which is needed to earn a score of 2.

Response 4

The steel rail wat tracks provided more jobs for people and more rail way transportation for people and they used a lot of iron. This also increased the price for the rail way tracks.

Score: 1

The response earns a 1. It offers a description of how the steel industry affected human resources by providing “more jobs for people.” However, “. . . used a lot of iron” is insufficient to describe the effect on natural resources.

Response 5

Steel affects many things. One way that steel affects human resources is because it costs less money. One way that steel affected natural resources is, it made fuel.

Score: 0

The response earns a 0. It does not accurately describe how improvements in steel production affected either human resources or natural resources.